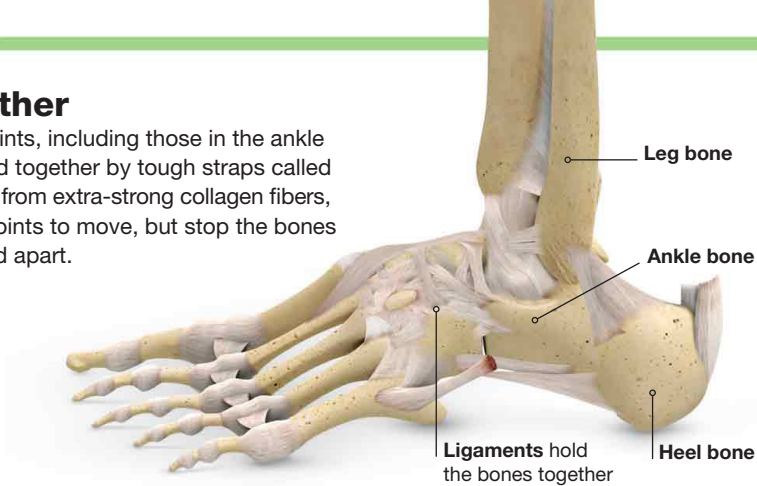


Held together

Many synovial joints, including those in the ankle and foot, are held together by tough straps called ligaments. Made from extra-strong collagen fibers, these allow the joints to move, but stop the bones from being pulled apart.



Out of joint

This X-ray shows how two finger bones, forming a knuckle joint, have been pulled apart. This is known as dislocation and occurs when a sudden blow or pull forces the bones out of line. Doctors treat dislocations by moving the bones back into their correct positions.